AWSAJ ACADEMY

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT

Meeting focus: see what is taught, find gaps, and examine how learning grows

LEADER DIRECTIONS

WHY ARE WE MEETING?

To build an honest K-12 picture of what students actually learn, where essential skills may be missed or unnecessarily repeated, and how learning should progress toward success on the mainstream pathway. It is also our evidence for CIS accreditation (Domain C, The Curriculum). **Our mindset: examine the curriculum, not individual teachers. This is for information only: it does not evaluate your teaching, and there is no right answer.**

GUIDING K-12 QUESTION

If a student begins at Awsaj in Kindergarten, what must they learn at each grade to be ready for Grade 12 and the mainstream pathway?

TODAY'S SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE Completed standards ratings + identified must-know skills, potential gaps or repetition, progression concerns, and burning questions for follow-up.

TEAM ROLES AND PREPARATION

FACILITATOR / TIMEKEEPER Leads, keeps time, runs the walk-through.	**RECORDER** Captures observations, questions, who should respond.
GRADE / SUBJECT REPS Share real practice; listen, question, collaborate.	**ADMINISTRATION** Supports attendance, collaboration, oversight.

BRING: Laptop, notebook or notepad, pen or pencil, an open mind and a great attitude.

STEP 1 RATE WHAT WAS ACTUALLY TAUGHT

Using last school year as evidence. Do not rate from a pacing guide alone.

ONLINE TOOL: sites.google.com/edi.qfschools.qa/ma3loomat/k-12-vertical-alignment. Choose your team (grade, subject or course). Rate each Common Core (CCSS) standard and Essential Element (EE), or your subject's standards.

First, the leader runs the ▶ Walk-Through Example (top of the team page) with everyone. Practice only, nothing is saved: **1** your standards, **2** the standards for the whole school, **3** how to rate, then each part of the rating page, zoomed in. Then each team opens its own team.

ALL OR NOTHING, K-12	
NOT TAUGHT	The standard is not being taught in any of the classes in the grade level.
INTRODUCED / EXPOSED	Anything in between. If only 3 out of 5 classes teach and assess it, choose Introduced, not Taught in depth.
TAUGHT IN DEPTH	**ALL** classes in the grade level consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard.

The goal is an accurate picture across all our classrooms, not just individual classes. Classes are not all the same, and the data should show that. Rate the teaching, not how well students learn or perform. For information only: it does not evaluate your teaching, and there is no right answer.

WORKED EXAMPLE: THE LEADER MODELS ONE, THEN THE GROUP RATES ONE

Ask aloud for every standard:

1. What does it ask students to do?
2. Which classes in our grade teach it? None = **Not taught**.
3. Some classes, or only briefly? = **Introduced / exposed**.
4. ALL classes teach, reteach, review and assess it? = **Taught in depth**.

Then the group rates the first standard on its own page together.

Example (Grade 3 Math, ★ Power standard):

M.3.NF.A.1 *(CCSS 3.NF.A.1)* Understand a unit fraction (e.g., 1/4) and that fractions are composed of unit fractions.

> *"Every Grade 3 class teaches it for three weeks, reteaches, reviews and tests it: Taught in depth. If only some classes did: Introduced / exposed."*

Tips: rate only your own grade's standards. Click an answer again to take it off. Answers save at once; **Finish** lists anything not answered.

STEP 2 REFLECT INDIVIDUALLY BEFORE DISCUSSING

1. What knowledge or essential skills are students missing when they arrive in your grade?

2. What essential prerequisite skills do students need when they enter your grade?

3. What essential skills should students demonstrate before moving to the next grade?

AWSAJ ACADEMY

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT

Team discussion · K-12 patterns · evidence to bring forward

LEADER DIRECTIONS

STEP 3 DISCUSS: WHAT ARE WE NOTICING?

Use the completed ratings and your reflections. The recorder should capture specific grades, standards and examples, not assumptions.

1. Which skills are taught in depth, only introduced, or not taught across grades?
2. What prerequisites do students seem to lack when they enter the next grade?
3. Where is learning repeated without greater complexity or independence?
4. How should Common Core standards and Essential Elements progress across K-12?

STEPS 4-6 LOOK ACROSS THE K-12 LEARNING JOURNEY

MUST-KNOW LEARNING

Name the essential skills students must carry into the next grade.

REFLECT: If this skill is missing, what becomes difficult later?

GAPS

Compare what the previous grade teaches with what the next grade expects. Check standards no grade has answered yet.

REFLECT: Where might prerequisite learning be missing?

UNNECESSARY REPETITION

Distinguish purposeful review from repeating the same tasks or difficulty.

REFLECT: Is learning becoming deeper and more independent?

PROGRESSION

Trace skills across grades and discuss increasing accuracy, reasoning, application, and independence.

REFLECT: What should this learning look like next year?

TOOL VIEWS: Coverage map = rated learning by grade and strand · Gaps & repetition = possible missing or duplicated skills · Progressions = how learning builds across grades · Grade dashboard = one grade, every subject. Choose **All subjects** in the Subject box to see every subject at once. A gap is only **confirmed** once every grade that could teach it has rated it.

RECORD TODAY'S KEY FINDINGS

Identify up to three high-priority observations. Record a specific grade or standard to verify.

PRIORITY SKILL / PATTERN	GRADE(S) AND STANDARD(S)	EVIDENCE / NEXT CHECK

BURNING QUESTIONS / CONCERNS

QUESTION OR CONCERN	ADDRESS TO (ADMIN / LEAD / COMMITTEE)

LEADER CHECKLIST

- ☐ Open the tool on the projector before the meeting
- ☐ Share why: honest picture, CIS, not an evaluation
- ☐ Run the Walk-Through Example with everyone
- ☐ Read the three rating levels aloud
- ☐ Model the worked example, then rate one together
- ☐ Show how to change or take off an answer
- ☐ Agree who finishes the ratings, and by when
- ☐ Check progress; remind the team to press Finish

NEXT MEETING 1. Agree on grade and subject-level expectations → 2. Define assessment evidence → 3. Share effective resources